

Stayman and Jacoby Transfers

The Stayman convention is used to find a 4-4 Major suit fit after one partner has opened 1NT or 2NT. Responder bids an artificial 2♣ and the Notrump bidder then bids a 4-card Major if she has one, or 2 or 3 ♦ otherwise.

The Jacoby Transfer convention is used to uncover a 5-3 Major suit fit after one partner has opened 1NT or 2NT. A response of ♦s asks opener to bid ♥s, a response of ♥s asks opener to bid ♠s.

The two conventions complement each other, that's why they are together in this set of practices.

Board: 1

Dealer: **North**

Contract: 3NT

Declarer: North

Lead: ♠3

Board: 2

Dealer: **East**

Contract: 2♠

Declarer: East

Lead: ♥3

Board: 3

Dealer: **South**

Contract: 4♥

Declarer: South

Lead: ♦J

Board: 4

Dealer: **West**

Contract: 4♠

Declarer: West

Lead: ♥5

Board 1

North Deals

None Vul

♠ 10 8 7

♥ K 5 4

♦ A 10 8 4

♣ K 10 5

♠ K J 4

♥ Q 10

♦ K Q J 6

♣ A 9 7 3



♠ Q 6 5 3 2

♥ 7 6 2

♦ 9 3

♣ Q 4 2

♠ A 9

♥ A J 9 8 3

♦ 7 5 2

♣ J 8 6

SOUTH has 11 points and five ♥s, so she responds 2♦ as a Jacoby Transfer.

When NORTH bids the required 2♥, SOUTH jumps to 3NT to show at least 11 points, but only a 5-card ♥ suit.

Since NORTH has only a doubleton ♥ she passes 3NT.

*West**North**East**South*

1NT

Pass

2♦

Pass

2♥

Pass

3NT

All Pass

3NT by North

Lead: ♠3

Board 2

East Deals

N-S Vul

♠ Q 8 7 6 3 2

♥ 8 5

♦ 9 5 4

♣ 5 3

♠ A 10

♥ K Q 10 9

♦ J 10 6 2

♣ 10 6 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K J 5

♥ A 7 6

♦ A 8 3

♣ K Q 9 4

♠ 9 4

♥ J 4 3 2

♦ K Q 7

♣ A J 8 7

EAST, with a balanced 17 point hand naturally opens 1NT.

WEST has a really awful hand, but she does hold six ♠s. So she uses Jacoby Transfer, and when EAST bids 2♠ she passes!

*West**North**East**South*

2♥

Pass

2♠

1NT

Pass

All Pass

2♠ by East

Lead: ♥3

Board 3

South Deals

E-W Vul

♠ 5 4
♥ K 7 4
♦ J 10 9 8
♣ Q J 9 7

♠ A K 7 2

♥ A J 8 6

♦ 5 3

♣ 10 8 4



♠ J 10 9 8

♥ 5 3

♦ K Q 4 2

♣ 6 5 2

♠ Q 6 3

♥ Q 10 9 2

♦ A 7 6

♣ A K 3

NORTH has four cards in each Major suit - this is an ideal situation for Stayman.

SOUTH shows a ♥ suit and NORTH immediately bids game in that suit.

West	North	East	South
			1NT
Pass	2♣	Pass	2♥
Pass	4♥		
All Pass			
4♥ by South			
Lead: ♦J			

Board 4

West Deals

Both Vul

♠ A Q 8 2
♥ A Q 3
♦ K 10 6 2
♣ A Q

♠ J 6

♥ 10 7 5

♦ A 8 5

♣ K 10 7 4 2

	N	
W		E
	S	

♠ K 9 7 4

♥ K 8 6 2

♦ 7 3

♣ 8 6 5

♠ 10 5 3

♥ J 9 4

♦ Q J 9 4

♣ J 9 3

West

2NT

3 ♠

All Pass

4 ♠ by West

Lead: ♥5

North

Pass

Pass

East

3 ♣

4 ♠

South

Pass

Stayman convention works just fine after a 2NT opening, just at a higher level.

EAST knows that 6 points will be enough for game opposite WEST's 20-21, she just needs to find out if there is a 4-4 Major suit fit. There is, in ♠s.